

hardware, content and services, from inception to production everything is within the Apple family. This was believed to be the key to Apple ensuring high- quality products that are reliable, easy to use and aesthetically appealing. Let's take for instance Apple's very own iTunes Store. By using iTunes and with an iPod we can take our digital content with us or save it on our computer. But at the same time it restricts our ability to share music by locking down easy music transfer onto someone else's iPod. Apple, through the iPod-iTunes service, gives the music industry greater control on how people use music. And the situation's the same



Apple's pioneering contribution in the touch-revolution: iPod, iPhone, iPad

with iPhone and iPad. Every single such product application is vetted through Apple which controls and monitors all resources. This same closed strategy in the past had prevented Apple from dominating markets against more open platforms like Windows from Microsoft Inc. during the PC turf wars in the late 1980s.

History may not always repeat itself, but too many restrictions placed on them may occasionally draw ire from the developers' communities forcing them to gravitate towards Android and other operating systems where they have full freedom to explore and exploit features. Adobe System's Flash not working on Apple products even today leaves a chunk of web content unviewable on your iPhone or iPad, and when such cases arise, the heavier champion will win. Either web sites will slowly let